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Hiring Team, Perplexity

Your posting says the Deal Desk Lead owns review and approvals end to end, applies policy consistently, and escalates only the calls that sit beyond their authority, with a clear recommendation attached. I already built the system that makes that call explainable: PriceKeel's guardrail engine reads a live discount exception inside the deal platform and recommends an approval limit learned from a company's own closed-won and closed-lost deals, with an audit trail Finance and Legal can act on before a deal ever reaches signature.

Before I built that tool I ran the other side of the desk. At Sensata I recovered $700K+ in margin in two quarters leading the Bleeders and Leakers program, negotiating nonstandard terms and exceptions against competitive gaps and customer willingness to pay, and raised distributor margins from 53% to 61% in under two quarters by repricing parts sold through distribution. I also closed AP26 revenue models and multimillion-dollar customer quotes directly with senior executives, the same deal-economics-under-pressure work your posting describes as partnering with the field to balance pricing, discounts, commitments and payment terms.

Running PriceKeel means I define the business requirements and acceptance criteria for my own quote-to-order workflow instead of inheriting someone else's CRM and CPQ stack, and I hold my own systems accountable for delivery the way your posting asks this seat to hold Systems accountable. I also hired and managed an 8-person team at Pixis, so building the Deal Desk function as Perplexity grows is not a new muscle. At Applied Materials I automate my own recurring pricing analysis with AI agents built on Claude instead of rebuilding the same report every cycle, which is the same lens your posting asks for on how AI is changing quote-to-order workflows.

What I would bring to Perplexity is someone who has already built deal-desk tooling from zero and closed a quantified margin gap inside a multi-$100M business, not someone learning the approval matrix on the job. Proof trail at adhi-pricing-ai.vercel.app/ref/perplexity.

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